Election-COS 1.0 Design System Protocol

1. Brand Essence

- **Voice:** Authoritative, calm, precise, empowering, and politically neutral.
- **Aesthetic:** "Paper and ink" civic document. Clean, exact, with strategic highlights.

2. Color Palette & WCAG 2.2 AA Accessibility

Strict adherence to color contrast ratios is mandatory to ensure accessibility and project institutional competence.

- **Ink (#1A2246):** Primary text, major headings, dark backgrounds, footer elements.
- **Paper (#F7F4EE):** Primary background color. Clean, neutral canvas.
- **Amber (#B7913F):** Accent color, primary call-to-action (CTA) buttons, status markers, warnings.
- **Slate (#6A6E7E):** Secondary text, captions, inactive states.
- **Blue (#33427E):** Links, secondary actions, informational accents.
- **Green (#2F7E4A):** Success states, "Built" claim badges.

CRITICAL ACCESSIBILITY RULES:

- **PASS:** Ink text on Paper background (14.05:1). Use for all primary body text.
- **PASS:** Amber text/UI on Ink background (5.24:1). Use for dark-mode CTAs.
- **FAIL:** Amber text on Paper background (2.68:1). **NEVER use Amber for body text or vital UI elements on a light background.**

3. Typography

- **Headings / Display:** Archivo (Weights: 700). Used for bold, civic-style declarations.
- **Body Text:** Public Sans (Weights: 400, 600). Used for ultimate legibility in dense data reports and UI menus. Line-height: 1.65.
- **Data / Monospace:** IBM Plex Mono. Exclusively used for IDs, ward codes (e.g., `NW405-W07`), IEC tracking numbers, and financial figures.

4. Layout & Grid Systems

- **Desktop ("War Room"):** 12-column grid, max width 1200px. Designed for dense data visualization, seat calculators, and campaign overviews.
- **Mobile ("Field"):** Single column, large 48px touch targets. Designed for field canvassers operating in poor signal areas on mid-range devices.

5. Imagery & Visual Rules

- **Style:** Authentic, diverse South African civic settings.
- **Prohibitions:**
  - NO generic stock cliches (e.g., stylized ballot boxes).
  - NO political party colors used as signifiers (e.g., avoiding solid red, green, or yellow backgrounds).
  - NO identifiable real-world party logos or candidate faces in product mockups.
- **UI Integration:** Use crisp, high-contrast vector mockups of the ECOS dashboard within promotional graphics to prove capability.

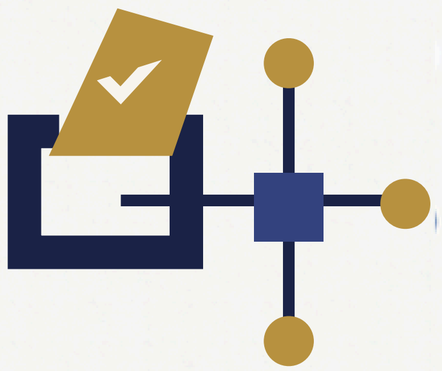
Election-COS1.0

Election Campaign Operating System 1.0

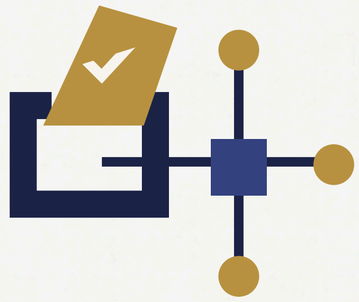
Democracy Through Computational Intelligence

electioncos.co.za

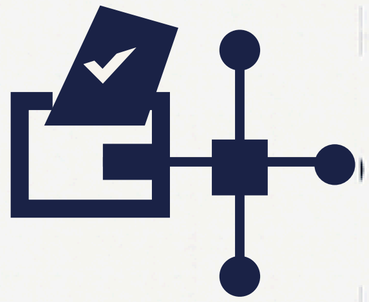
SYMBOL — PRIMARY



SYMBOL — COMPACT



SYMBOL — MONOCHROME



CLEARSPACE



MINIMUM SIZE

PRINT



20 mm

DIGITAL



24 px

SYSTEM LABEL: ELECTION OPERATIONS PLATFORM

Version 1.0

Election-COS1.0 Brand Architecture

Election Campaign Operating System 1.0 · electioncos.co.za



BRAND HIERARCHY

- **Election Campaign Operating System 1.0**
  Parent Identity
- **Election-COS1.0**
  Product shorthand
- **Civic campaign operations platform**
  Descriptor
- **electioncos.co.za**
  Digital destination

BRAND VOICE

Authoritative, calm, precise, empowering, and politically neutral.

TYPOGRAPHY

Archivo 700
Headings and display

Public Sans 400 / 600
Body and UI - Line-height 1.65

IBM Plex Mono
IDs, ward codes, IEC tracking numbers, and financial figures

LAYOUT SYSTEMS

1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10 11 12

War Room - 12-column grid - max width 1,200 px

Field - single column - 48 px touch targets

COLOUR ROLES

Ink #1A2246	Primary text, headings, dark fields, footer elements
Paper #F7F4EE	Background
Amber #B7913F	Buttons, alerts, focus, action highlights
Blue #33427E	Links, secondary actions
Slate #6A6E7E	Captions, secondary labels
Green #2F7E4A	Built status markers
Roadmap #8A6A2A	Roadmap status markers
Line #DCD6C8	Borders only

STATUS BADGE EXAMPLES

Built (delivered)

BUILT

Roadmap (planned)

ROADMAP

ACCESSIBILITY (WCAG 2.2 AA)

Ink text on Paper: PASS

Amber UI on Ink: PASS

Amber text on Paper: NEVER

LOGO USAGE

Never redraw the symbol.

Use the approved symbol only: Primary, Compact or Monochrome.

Keep clearspace X clear.

Do not alter spelling or punctuation.

IMAGERY RULES



- Authentic, diverse South African civic settings.
- No generic ballot-box clichés.
- No political party colour signifiers.
- No identifiable real-world party logos.
- No candidate faces in product mockups.
- People shown in natural, respectful civic work.

DO / DON'T

DO

- Use the approved colours.
- Use approved typography.
- Follow layout systems.
- Prioritise clarity and access.
- Keep it neutral and civic.

DON'T

- Don't use unauthorised logos.
- Don't add new colours.
- Don't distort typography.
- Don't use cliché symbols.
- Don't personalise politics.

DIGITAL DESTINATION
electioncos.co.za

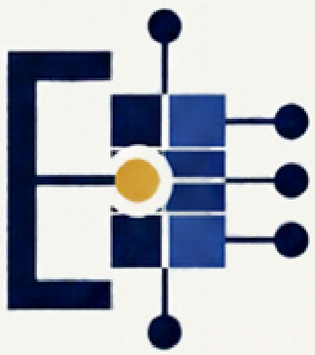
VERSION

1.0

Election-COS1.0

Election Campaign Operating System 1.0
electioncos.co.za

PRIMARY HORIZONTAL LOCKUP

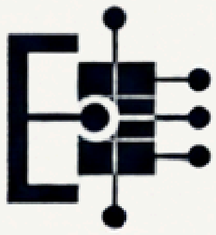


Election-COS1.0
Election Campaign Operating System 1.0
electioncos.co.za

SYMBOL-ONLY MARK



MONOCHROME VERSION



Election-COS1.0
Election Campaign Operating System 1.0
electioncos.co.za

CLEARSPACE



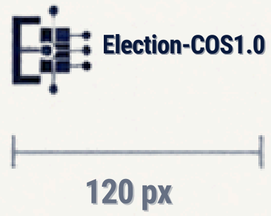
Clearspace is defined as X.
No text, graphics or other elements
should encroach this area.

MINIMUM SIZE

PRINT



DIGITAL



Election-COS1.0 Brand Architecture

Election Campaign Operating System 1.0 • electioncos.co.za

BRAND HIERARCHY

Parent identity	**Election Campaign Operating System 1.0**
Product shorthand	**Election-COS1.0**
Descriptor	**Civic campaign operations platform**
Digital destination	**electioncos.co.za**



BRAND VOICE

Authoritative, calm, precise, empowering, and politically neutral.

COLOUR SYSTEM & ROLES

Ink	#1A2246	Primary text, major headings, dark fields, and footer elements
Paper	#F7F4EE	Page background
Amber	#B7913F	Buttons, alerts, focus, and action highlights
Blue	#33427E	Links and secondary actions
Slate	#6A6E7E	Captions and secondary labels
Line	#DCD6C8	Borders only
Built Green	#2F7E4A	Status: complete, confirmed, on track
Roadmap	#8A6A2A	Status: planned, in progress

AA WCAG 2.2 AA GUIDANCE

- Ink text on Paper
- Amber text or UI on Ink
- Never Amber body text on Paper

TYPE SYSTEM

Display & Headings	**Archivo 700**
Body & UI (Regular)	Public Sans 400
Body & UI (Semibold)	**Public Sans 600**
Data & Code	`IBM Plex Mono`

TYPE SCALE (DESKTOP)

H1	**Archivo 700**	**48/52**
H2	**Archivo 700**	**32/36**
H3	**Archivo 700**	**24/30**
Body	Public Sans 400/600	16/26
Small	Public Sans 400	14/23
Caption	Public Sans 400	12/20
Code	`IBM Plex Mono`	14/22

Line height for body and UI: 1.65 for optimal readability and accessibility.

STATUS BADGE EXAMPLES

BUILT • COMPLETE

ROADMAP • IN PROGRESS

LAYOUT ARCHITECTURE

WAR ROOM (DESKTOP)

12-column grid

Max content width: 1,200 px

FIELD (MOBILE)

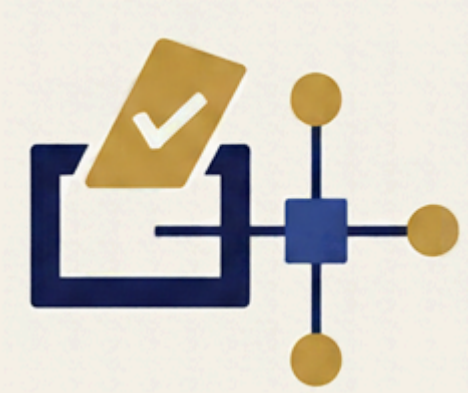
Single column

Min touch target: 48 px

DO	DON'T
✓ Use authentic, diverse South African civic settings	✗ Use ballot-box clichés or political iconography
✓ Keep communications clear, factual, and neutral	✗ Use party colours, logos, or candidate faces
✓ Use the approved colour roles and type system	✗ Use Amber body text on Paper

IMAGERY RULES

Use authentic, diverse South African civic settings that reflect real communities and operations.
Do not use generic ballot-box clichés, political party colour signifiers, identifiable party logos, or candidate faces in product mockups.



Election-COS1.0

- Democracy Through Computational Intelligence

electioncos.co.za